

Philipp Hilbert. *Platform PM building API marketplaces from zero.*

Positioning, Product leader with 13 years shipping 0-to-1 platforms, ready to define, package, and commercially launch the HTS API Marketplace.

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§ WHY HOPPER

Hopper's HTS division has done something genuinely rare: it turned proprietary fintech into a B2B platform that powers Capital One, Air Canada, and Nubank simultaneously, that is a distribution story, not just a product story. The opening for an API Marketplace that packages capabilities like Search Polygons, Ranking, and the Custom Deals Engine into enterprise-grade, commercially coherent products is exactly the kind of 0-to-1 scope I have built before: at Kvitt Payments I took a product from zero to acquisition inside the girocard ecosystem, and at EMIL Group I shipped Claims Center from concept to production in a multi-team insurance SaaS environment. What attracts me here specifically is the mandate to own the commercial model, take rate structure, platform vs. variable fees, per-capability unit economics, alongside the developer experience: that full stack from pricing design to sandbox onboarding is where I work best. *That combination of platform economics and developer empathy is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo prototyping and spec generation
- **Cursor / VSCode**, agentic refactors and API mock-ups
- **Lovable**, rapid partner portal and onboarding UI prototypes
- **GitHub Copilot**, pair programming and edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

- **GPT**, research, documentation drafts, and prompt iteration
 - **Gamma.app**, stakeholder deck generation from structured notes
 - **Framer**, design-heavy interface mockups
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, OpenShift, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD with Jenkins, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQL, REST APIs, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Git.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace built solo to take the headhunter out of construction staffing.

- Matches construction firms with workers directly; anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface, minimising onboarding friction for non-technical users.
 - LLM agents across the full funnel so a single operator runs day-to-day matching and conversion.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL, directly transferable to HTS partner onboarding and time-to-first-value tracking.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT HOPPER

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Spend the week in deep listening sessions with the capability PMs who own HTS Connect, Ranking, Content Mapping, and the Extranet, mapping each capability's current integration surface, its roadmap constraints, and the customisation knobs partners actually reach for, so I know what I have to package before I invent anything.

WEEK 2

Prototype the packaging.

Build a working mock of the marketplace's capability catalogue, using Lovable or Claude Code, that lets commercial and a test partner click through a notional onboarding flow, so I can validate the packaging model and pricing surface with real reactions before a single engineering sprint is committed.

WEEK 3 +

Close the first loop.

Pick the one capability with the clearest partner demand and the least integration complexity, write the API spec, align with the capability PM on the sandbox environment, and hand a complete integration package to the first enterprise partner, generating the first real time-to-first-value data point the marketplace P&L can be measured against.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hopper Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the Principal Product Manager role for the HTS API Marketplace. The mandate, define what the marketplace is, own the commercial model, and build the developer experience from scratch, matches the kind of work I have done repeatedly, most recently as a solo founder building a two-sided B2B marketplace in construction staffing and before that shipping the Claims Center at EMIL Group from concept to production. Zero-to-one is not a phase I have observed; it is a mode I have operated in.

The specific challenge you are describing is a packaging and commercialisation problem layered on top of existing technical capabilities. The underlying systems, connectivity orchestration, pricing and sort, content mapping, exist. What the marketplace needs is someone who can translate those capabilities into externally-consumable API products with coherent pricing, clear onboarding, and a commercial model that scales. At Kvitt Payment Solutions I built a P2P fintech product from zero that was subsequently acquired and operated inside the Sparkasse girocard ecosystem. At EMIL Group I restructured a failing 18-person delivery organisation and shipped a claims product that had no prior precedent, both required exactly the cross-team coordination, commercial framing, and developer-facing documentation discipline you are asking for here.

On the AI-native working style: I prototype before I write PRDs. For construct8, my current side project, every workflow, matching logic, onboarding, funnel analytics, was first mocked with Claude Code or Lovable and validated with real users before engineering touched it. I use SQL for funnel and conversion analysis as a daily habit, not a once-a-quarter exercise. For the HTS

Marketplace specifically, I would reach for a mock API catalogue and a clickable partner onboarding flow in week two, well before a sprint is planned, so that the capability PMs and the commercial team are reacting to something real rather than a slide.

The platform economics question, take rate structure per capability, platform vs. variable fees, the custom deals framework for large partners, is one I find genuinely interesting. My background spans fintech at Kvitt, B2B SaaS at EMIL, and public-sector data platforms at Bundesagentur für Arbeit, all of which required modelling unit economics and making pricing decisions that balanced partner incentives against platform sustainability. Owning the marketplace revenue P&L and tracking GBV and per-capability take rates alongside Finance is a scope I am built for.

The travel commerce domain is new to me, I have not previously shipped lodging or car inventory products. What I bring instead is a demonstrated ability to learn technical domain constraints fast (I came into defence AI and into insurance SaaS both as an outsider and shipped in both within weeks), and a transferable fluency in marketplace mechanics, API product design, and enterprise partner management. I would rather name that honestly than overstate a match.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager and product owner with 13 years of ownership across fintech, insurance B2B SaaS, public-sector analytics, and defence AI platforms. I have built two-sided marketplaces from zero, shipped API-facing products end-to-end, and owned commercial models from take-rate design to revenue P&L. I work AI-natively, prototyping with Claude Code, Lovable, and Cursor before committing engineering, and I am fluent in SQL and large-scale data pipelines. My most transferable credential for this role: I have taken 0-to-1 products to commercial launch multiple times, in regulated and cross-functional environments, without losing the underlying engineering teams.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Platform and Marketplace PM: 0-to-1 product definition, API product design, developer experience, enterprise packaging and commercial modelling, take-rate and pricing structure, partner onboarding, time-to-first-value optimisation, go-to-market sequencing.

B2B SaaS and Enterprise Products: B2B requirements engineering, cross-team dependency mapping, capability packaging, enterprise partner management, multi-phase rollouts.

AI-native Prototyping: rapid mockups with Lovable, Framer, Claude Code, Cursor; LLM agent workflows; prompt and context engineering; human-in-the-loop design.

Data and Analytics: SQL, funnel and conversion analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MicroStrategy, Matomo.

Machine Learning and AI Platforms: ML pipeline product ownership, Explainable AI (XAI), EU AI Act compliance, data provenance and audit trail design.

Fintech and Payments: P2P payment product design, PSP integration, girocard ecosystem, mobile payment UX, edge-case and fraud-path handling.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, PI planning, backlog refinement, sprint discipline, velocity tracking, CI/CD and GitOps release management.

Insurance: B2B SaaS for insurers, reinsurers and brokers; claims product delivery; insurance product launch.

Governance and Security: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, quantum-resistant encryption product ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Led cross-functional team of 15+ through Scrum; GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut deployment time from days to 30 minutes; 200% pipeline-run increase by redirecting strategy to developer-code-first workflows.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS PLATFORM 2023-2024

Integrated Dagster and dbt into ETL pipeline, saving 75% time per data update; containerised a bare-metal system; Deputy IT Security Officer. SQL-driven KPI instrumentation across national labour-market datasets.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% of features; user acceptance rose fivefold. Implemented CGM/KIS interface, reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured 18-person organisation into three lean teams; attrition near-zero. Shipped Claims Center 0-to-1. Cut new insurance product time-to-market from months to under one week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS POS 2021-2022

SAFe delivery across agile release trains; moved research output to production in a matrix organisation.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT SECURE DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B PROCUREMENT 2019-2020

Migrated legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; still in production.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · CLINICAL NETWORK INFRASTRUCTURE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Solo 0-to-1 two-sided B2B marketplace; LLM agents across the funnel; SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped three-layer encryption product installing in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO · NANOTECHNOLOGY AND AGRICULTURE 2018-2021

Laboratory to investor rounds; financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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